今天是我的生日

他们都忘了吗?

It's My Birthday

Has everyone forgotten?

Text and translation by Claude (Anthropic)

Footnotes mark names and words above HSK 1 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 今天是九月十号，星期五。这是小雨[†]的生日。小雨今天九岁了。早上，她很早就起床了。她想：“今天是我的生日，爸爸妈妈会说什么呢？”

九月十号

2 爸爸在看手机，妈妈在准备早饭。“爸爸，妈妈，早上好！今天是几月几号？”爸爸没有看她：“九月十号。怎么了？”“今天星期几？”“星期五。快吃饭吧，你要上学了。”妈妈说。小雨不说话了。他们不知道今天是她的生日吗？

他们都忘了吗？

3 在学校，小雨也不高兴。方方[‡]是她的好朋友。去年九月十号，方方给了她一本书。今年，方方什么都没有说。

† 小雨 *Xiǎoyǔ* Xiaoyu

‡ 方方 *Fāngfang* Fangfang

Today is the tenth of September, a Friday. It is Xiaoyu's birthday. Today Xiaoyu is nine. She got up very early that morning. She thought, "It's my birthday today. What will Mum and Dad say?" 1

The Tenth of September

Dad was looking at his phone, and Mum was getting breakfast ready. "Morning, Dad! Morning, Mum! What's the date today?" Dad didn't look up. "The tenth of September. Why?" "What day of the week is it?" "Friday. Hurry up and eat, it's time for school," said Mum. Xiaoyu fell silent. Didn't they know that today was her birthday? 2

Have They All Forgotten?

At school, Xiaoyu wasn't happy either. Fangfang was her best friend. Last year on the tenth of September, Fangfang had given her a book. This year, Fangfang hadn't said a thing. 3

4 下课了，方方[†]和几个同学在门口说话。小雨[‡]来了，他们就不说了。“你们在说什么？”“没什么，没什么！”方方笑着说。小雨想：“方方也忘记了。”中午，她一个人吃了午饭。

回家

5 下午四点，放学了。爸爸开车来学校。在车上，爸爸也没有说生日的事。回到家，小雨打开门。家里没有人说话。“妈妈？奶奶？”

6 房间里的人都跑出来了：“小雨，生日好！”妈妈、奶奶、方方，还有好几个同学，都在她家！方方笑着说：“下课的时候，我们在说这个！”

7 桌子上有很多菜，也有奶奶做的面条儿。奶奶说：“生日要吃面条儿。吃了面条儿，身体好！”

† 方方 *Fāngfang* Fangfang

‡ 小雨 *Xiǎoyǔ* Xiaoyu

When class ended, Fangfang and a few classmates were talking by the door. 4
When Xiaoyu came over, they stopped. "What are you talking about?" "Nothing, nothing!" said Fangfang with a grin. Xiaoyu thought, "Fangfang has forgotten too." At lunchtime she ate on her own.

Home

At four in the afternoon school finished. Dad drove to the school to pick her 5
up. In the car, Dad didn't mention her birthday either. When they got home, Xiaoyu opened the door. No one in the house was talking. "Mum? Grandma?"

Everyone came running out of the room. "Happy birthday, Xiaoyu!" Mum, 6
Grandma, Fangfang and quite a few classmates were all there in her home! Fangfang laughed. "That's what we were talking about after class!"

The table was full of dishes, and there were noodles that Grandma had 7
made. Grandma said, "On your birthday you have to eat noodles. Eat your noodles and you'll stay healthy!"

7 方方[†]给了小雨[‡]一个新书包，同学们给了她很多本子和书。爸爸妈妈给了她一些新衣服。

8 小雨说：“早上我想，你们都忘记了！”奶奶笑了：“我们都记得。九月十号，我们的小雨九岁了！”这是小雨最高兴的一个生日。

† 方方 *Fāngfang* Fangfang

‡ 小雨 *Xiǎoyǔ* Xiaoyu

Fangfang gave Xiaoyu a new schoolbag, and the classmates gave her lots of notebooks and books. Mum and Dad gave her some new clothes. 7

Xiaoyu said, "This morning I thought you'd all forgotten!" Grandma laughed. "We all remembered. On the tenth of September, our Xiaoyu turned nine!" It was the happiest birthday Xiaoyu had ever had. 8